Get paid closer to your terms.

Three pages: the checks to make on your own side, the reminder rhythm, the wording to paste, and a stop-supply rule your sales team can live with. Change the square brackets and use it today.

01 Before you chase: five checks on your own side

Late payment often starts before the customer does anything. Fix these first, because no reminder can rescue an invoice that never reached the person who pays.

1. **The invoice leaves within 24 hours of the delivery or the job.** Every day it waits on your side is a day added to their terms.
2. **It carries their reference.** A purchase order number, a contract number or the name of the person who ordered. No reference is the most common reason an invoice sits in an approval queue.
3. **It goes to the person who pays, with the person who ordered in copy.** Ask every customer once: "Which address do invoices go to, and when is your payment run?"
4. **The due date is written as a date.** "Due 18 December 2026", not "30 days".
5. **Paying is easy.** Bank details and your PayNow details are on the invoice, and the customer knows which invoice number to quote.

02 The rhythm

WHEN	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO
Invoice day	Invoice sent. For large invoices, ask: "Is anything missing for approval?"	Accounts
7 days before due	Large invoices only: a one-line heads-up with the invoice attached again	Accounts
Day 1 overdue	Reminder 1 (page 2). Friendly, assumes an oversight	Accounts
Day 7	Reminder 2 with the statement of account. Asks for a payment date	Accounts
Day 14	Reminder 3, then a phone call the next working day. Mentions the hold rule	Account owner
Day 21	Hold decision under the stop-supply rule (page 3), or a payment plan in writing	Director or finance lead
Day 30 and after	Director to director. Decide whether to take formal steps, with proper advice	Director

The 10-minute Monday routine

1. Open the list of unpaid invoices, oldest first. 2. Send that day's reminders: anything that reached day 1, 7 or 14 since last Monday. 3. Write the promised payment date beside every reply. A promise without a date is not a promise. 4. Tell sales which accounts are on hold **before** they take the next order. One person owns this routine, and one person covers when they are on leave.

03 Three reminders, one statement note, one call

Email versions. For WhatsApp, use the first two sentences and attach the invoice. Keep every message to one invoice or one total, one question, one date.

DAY 1 Reminder 1: assume an oversight

Subject: Invoice [number], [amount], due [date]
Hi [Name], a quick note that invoice [number] for [amount] was due on [date] and we have not seen the payment yet. A copy is attached. If it has been paid, please ignore this and send me the payment reference so I can match it. If something is holding it up on your side, such as a missing PO or a question on the amount, tell me today and I will sort it out.
Thank you, [Your name]

DAY 7 Reminder 2: ask for a date

Subject: Invoice [number] is 7 days overdue: payment date?
Hi [Name], invoice [number] for [amount] is now 7 days past its due date of [date]. Your statement is attached; the total overdue is [amount]. Could you reply with the date we can expect payment? If the invoice is waiting for approval, tell me who it is with and I will contact them directly.
Thank you, [Your name]

DAY 14 Reminder 3: firm, and fair warning

Subject: Invoice [number], 14 days overdue: please confirm by [day, date]
Hi [Name], invoice [number] for [amount] is 14 days overdue and I do not yet have a payment date. Please confirm by [day, date] when it will be paid. Under our credit terms we pause new orders on accounts more than [21] days overdue, and I would much rather not get there. I will call you tomorrow morning to settle this.
Regards, [Your name]

MONTHLY Statement cover note

Hi [Name], your statement at [date] is attached. Total outstanding is [amount], of which [amount] is overdue. The two oldest are [number] and [number]. Could you check it against your records and tell me about anything you do not recognise? If all is in order, when is your next payment run?

DAY 15 The call: four questions

1. Did you receive the invoice, and is it the right one to pay from?
2. Is anything on it disputed? If yes, what, and how much is not disputed?
3. Who approves it, and when is your next payment run?
4. What date shall I write down?

Never end the call without a date. Confirm it in one line by email the same day.

Send these in your own company's name. They are reminders, not legal notices: they make no threats and state no legal position. If a customer disputes an invoice, settle the dispute first and ask them to pay the undisputed part meanwhile.

04 A stop-supply rule your sales team can live with

Reminders only work if something happens when they are ignored. Put this in your credit terms and tell customers when they open an account, not when they are already late.

1. Every credit customer has terms and a credit limit, in writing.
2. An account with any invoice more than **[21]** days overdue, or over its limit, goes **on hold**: no new orders are delivered until it is cleared or a payment plan is agreed in writing.
3. Only **[the director or finance lead]** can release a hold, in writing, with the reason.
4. Sales see the hold list every Monday, before they take orders.
5. The customer is told before the hold starts (Reminder 3). Never after a delivery has been refused.

DAY 21 Hold notice

> Hi [Name], as mentioned last week, invoice [number] for [amount] is now more than [21] days overdue, so under our credit terms the account is on hold from today. We will release your next order as soon as the payment is received, or once we have agreed a payment plan in writing. I would like to get this cleared quickly. Can we speak today?

05 The one number to watch: days to get paid

Days to get paid = amounts customers owe you ÷ credit sales in the period × days in the period.

Worked example (example figures): customers owe S$310,000; credit sales in the last 90 days were S$600,000.
310,000 ÷ 600,000 × 90 = **46.5 days**.

On 30-day terms that is **16.5 days late**.

Cash tied up beyond your terms: S$600,000 ÷ 90 × 16.5 = **about S$110,000**.

Work yours out once a month. If the number falls, the routine is working.

Free tools for this, at tools.gantry.work: a statement of account generator, an ageing report builder and a days-to-get-paid calculator.

Want a second pair of eyes on your own list?

Send me your list of unpaid invoices: invoice date, due date, amount and a customer code. No customer names are needed. Within 48 working hours you get **one page back**: who to chase first, your real days to get paid, and the step where the delay starts, with a 5-minute recording that talks you through it. Free, and no pitch unless you ask for one. **Message me PAID LIST on LinkedIn.**